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All right, yeah, once again, thank you so much for participating. Today I want to talk a bit about homesickness and voice recordings, some other factors and variables. But first of all, how are you feeling today?

I'm feeling pretty good.

All right. Yeah. And just to check, could you tell me where you're from originally?

I'm originally from Donegal in Ireland.

Yeah. And so is that also the same place where you grew up?

Yeah, I was born and raised there.

All right. And where do you currently live?

I currently live in Amsterdam.

Okay. And do you consider that to be home or is that something else for you?

Yeah. The longer that I've lived away from Ireland, the tougher it is to say where is home. Yeah. But I think Amsterdam has become home.

Yeah. All right. And do you remember a time in your life when you were the most homesick or maybe very homesick? And do you know when this was and what you were homesick for?

It comes in waves. I would say that I still get homesick sometimes. Yeah. Mostly for my family and for the environment as well. I grew up in the countryside. Yeah. I understand.

And what does that homesickness kind of feel like for you?

It feels like a part of me is missing. Yeah. That my heart is somewhere else. And yeah. Yeah. Missing connection. I guess.

Yeah. I get that. And I want to look into voice recordings and then specifically how personal or generic they could feel. And then with personal I kind of mean not necessarily that they originate from someone close to you, but they need to invoke a personal connection. So it could be linguistical, historical, cultural, anything that makes it feel personally connected to you. And a generic voice recording would be

just one that doesn't invoke that personal connection. And if you were to think about voice recordings, which could be many things, it could also be recordings of spoken word, books, anything you can think of that has just the voice in it. What do you think would be types of voice recordings or characteristics of those that would make it feel more personal for you?

I would definitely have more of a connection if it was like a voice with an Irish accent. Yeah. Yeah. Or. Yeah. I think that's the main thing. It's to hear the language with an accent.

All right. And would you say, because you said with an Irish accent, would you say then just like English with an Irish accent or would you have more, if I'm correct, is it Gaelic? Would you have more of a connection with that, do you think, or just with Irish accent in English?

Um, I wasn't raised speaking Gaelic, so I learned it in school, so I still have a connection with it. Yeah. Um, but I would, yeah, I wasn't raised speaking that at all, so I would have more of a connection with like an Irish accent speaking English, to be honest.

Yeah. Okay. So, what I'm going to do now, I'm going to share another link with you, and it's a link to another questionnaire, um, and I want you to just keep it open at all times during the interview.

Sure.

And it's going to correspond to a listening task I want to perform, so I'm going to let you hear five voice recordings, five different ones. Um, and if everything went right, then the first thing you're going to see is to ask for the identifier again, so just the email address or phone number that you filled in.

Uh, yeah. I see that. Yeah.

So, what we're then going to be doing is rating the voice recordings that I'm going to let you hear based on how generic or how personal they feel to you. So, the first statement you're going to see is something about someone from a different country talking in a different language about the weather, for example. Um, I'm going to let you hear a voice recording that corresponds with that, and based on that recording, you can fit in the scale, and each recording corresponds to one item. So, the next statement is going to be about the next recording.

Okay. One question per recording.

Yeah. Exactly. And then after five recordings, we can switch back to the interview, and we're going to do that two more times later. But you can just keep it open then. Um, so please let me know when you're ready to listen, and also let me know if anything is unclear or it's not loud enough, anything like that.

Yeah. Okay. I'm ready.

All right.

[Voice recording audio: recording 1]

[Voice recording audio: recording 2]

All right. So, ready for the third one?

Yep.

[Voice recording audio: recording 9]

[Voice recording audio: recording 16]

All right. And the final one.

[Voice recording audio: recording 23]

All right. Yeah. So you can just keep it open, then we're going to go back to the interview. And I would like to ask you, based on these five recordings and the ratings that you gave, what did you think were specific elements of the recordings themselves, or maybe the specific elements of the voices that affected that personal or genericness, and what made it more personal or what made it more generic?

Yeah. Let me just look at my answers again. Yeah. Yeah. So the first couple of voice recordings, they were in French, right? So I feel like because I've been to France and I've heard the language before or whatever, no people that are French, then it wasn't as generic as it could have been for me. So I kind of, I didn't put it as very generic, but just generic.

Yeah.

I didn't understand what was being said, but it sounded familiar. And then when it came to the Irish accent, talking about the weather, I rated that as very personal, I rated that as a child, I rated that as a child, so that would be more personal than the historical speech and the St. Patrick's Day, right?

Yeah. All right. And why would you say the historical speech and the St. Patrick's Day are a little bit less personal? Is that because of the weather being the thing that you heard every day and this being less frequent?

Yeah. I think so. I would say also with the more political speech and also the, yeah, specifically with the more political speech, it's less emotional. And then the last one about the St. Patrick's Day, right? It's, um, that's also quite a, like a generic sort of,

um, thing associated with Ireland. So it's not so personal to me, but more of a general thing. Yeah

Yeah. Um, all right, so I want to move on to, um, the meaningfulness of a voice recording now. And it's kind of a nuanced difference, uh, but it's more or less whether recording feels in any way important or relevant to you and whether it actually means something to you, um, which can be, of course, uh, emotionally, but it can also be without emotions reminding you of something significant. And a voice recording could also, for example, be very personal, but not that meaningful. Uh, but one could also be not that personal or meaningful. Um, so I'm just going to let you think about that one again. And if you were to think about voice recordings in general, what do you think would make them more meaningful to you?

Um, can you explain again just the, what you mean by meaningful versus personal?

Yeah. So I'm going to try to not be, uh, too suggestive, but I think of maybe an example that would be, uh, not that personal. So for example, um, what you said about St. Patrick's day, that's not that personal for you because it's like a generic day just for everyone in Ireland. It's, I mean, it's a national holiday, so there's some connection. So it's meaningful maybe in a way that you care about Ireland. So it's important for Ireland as a whole, but not necessarily for you specifically. So it has meaning, but it's not that personal. Yeah. Um, and something else that can be very personal might be someone, I don't know, talking to you one-on-one, but it's about something you don't really care about. So that's very personal, but you don't really care about the information they're kind of conveying to you.

Okay, yeah.

And if you think at any point it's difficult, you just don't know, you can also just say that and that's perfectly fine. Um, so based on that, do you think, um, or what do you think would make a voice recording meaningful? Like what characteristics or maybe topics, uh, anything like that?

Um, yeah, I feel like it would really depend, um, what's going on and what's affecting me, um, and life in my family. Um, um, yeah, yeah, it really could be, um, anything. It's kind of hard to say.

Yeah, but that's, um, yeah, no, but that's interesting that you say it could be anything and it's kind of affected by how you are feeling and what you're doing, because that was going to be my next question. It was to ask you to think about, uh, different situations. So for example, being alone or surrounded by people or feeling homesick or not. And then thinking about one, having one specific voice recording that would maybe be more meaningful in one of those situations and less meaningful in another. And you already just said it, you were kind of influenced by maybe your mood and,

uh, how you're feeling, what you're doing. So could you, you think of a specific situation or two situations in which the one specific voice recording would be more meaningful than in the other situation?

Um, yeah, I mean, depending, like on how homesick I feel, then like, uh, a phone call or like, uh, a voice memo from my mom is going to impact me differently. Yeah. Um, then when I'm like immersed and like busy in my life here and not thinking about home. Yeah.

Um, yeah. That's great. Thanks.

It's hard to think of like, it's hard to think of a specific, um, example. Yeah. Does music also count as a voice recording?

It does count as long as it's music in which voice is used and primary. That's fine.

Yeah. Um, yeah, because I feel like if I was to hear a song or a tune, um, that's Irish and stuff, like unexpectedly, then that could also make me homesick sometimes. Um, like, really, like, trigger emotion as well.

Yeah. So do you think if you would listen to, um, because you just said like an Irish, uh, song, if you were to hear it unexpectedly, it could kind of worsen that. Do you think if you would intentionally listen to it, that it could also be good for it? Like good for an alleviation?

Yeah. I think it's just. Yeah. Because I do, I, listen to the radio for my home time sometimes. Yeah. I can like connect it, um, online and I would just have that play in. Yeah. Um, I was, yeah. And that's to like make me feel better or make me feel more connected to home. Yeah. But then, um, yeah, if I, if I wasn't to choose to put that on and I heard something randomly, then it can also pull me out of the mindset that I'm going to make me feel a bit bad.

Yeah. Yeah. I can understand that. And, um, I want to go back to the questionnaire now and I'm just going to let you hear the same five recordings. And then what's next, uh, what's going to be asked of you is to rate them again, but this time based on how meaningful they feel to you. So ranging from not meaningful at all to very meaningful. Um, I'm just going to get them here. All right. You can tell me when you're ready, then I'll let you hear the first one.

Okay.

All right.

[Voice recording audio: recording 1]

All right, ready?

Yes.

[Voice recording audio: recording 2]

[Voice recording audio: recording 9]

[Voice recording audio: recording 16]

[Voice recording audio: recording 23]

All right. So, now that you have the ratings for the meaningfulness, what do you think are elements or characteristics of the recordings and the situations, or maybe the voices themselves, that make it more or less meaningful to you, and why?

I already skipped ahead from the questions, but the two first ones I rated as, like, not meaningful at all, because I couldn't get meaning from them because I didn't understand the language, of course.

Yeah.

And then with the weather report from Ireland, I found that more meaningful. Not crazy, but the second to last one, just because it was... Yeah, she also had, like, a softer voice as well. It was, like, a little bit... It was more uplifting. She said that it was going to be sunny as well, and that had a bit more of a positive kind of context. So, that was meaningful to me. It made me think of, like, a sunny day at home, and also brought me back to just, you know, sitting watching the news with my parents and hearing the weather forecast, and that was, like, a nice memory. And then the second one with the speech from the president I think? One of the older presidents?

Yes. Well, at least a little while ago. Yeah. I think in the 90s.

Yeah. Yeah. So I think I was too young to, like, recognize her voice. So, therefore, it had a little bit less meaning. Um, but then she also said an Irish *mo ghile mear* at the end, and that always is quite meaningful to me. Um, so I rated one pretty high. And then lastly, with the St. Patrick's Parade, um, I rated it less meaningful just because it's quite a, uh, kind of standard national holiday, and it's like a, it's a quite a touristy thing too. There's also a tourist's, uh, voice in there. Yeah. Which kind of made it less meaningful yesterday. Yeah.

Yeah. Yeah. All right. Um, so for the next thing I want to talk about the actual supportiveness for coping with homesickness. So, basically, whether you feel like the recording would actually alleviate your feeling of homesickness, if you were to have it, and to what extent.. I think you're back now, did you hear what I said?

You were frozen. I am not sure, is it my connection?

I am not sure

I can try to connect to my phone

I think it's okay now. All right, so I mean, whether you feel like the voice recording actually would alleviate your feeling of homesickness, and to what extent? So, if you would once again think about voice recordings just in general, what do you think might impact that supportiveness? So what might worsen the homesickness? What might actually alleviate the homesickness?

Um, for me, I think it's like a choice thing. That if you're feeling homesick already and you choose to listen to something to make you feel better, then it can alleviate it. But, yeah, if you are reminded of home, um, kind of unexpectedly or, or to hear a voice recording unexpectedly, then that can, like, kind of make it worse.

Yeah. So intention would be a big factor in if it would actually alleviate it or not. Um, and could you think of a situation or situations in which one specific voice recording, um, you would feel was more supportive for coping with homesickness in one situation and less in another?

Yeah. Um, yeah, I think the same example of like, when I listened to the, um, the radio for my hometown. And then another, um, sometimes if I hear like, um, an Irish accent on the street or like people, um, that I know from, from home. Or that are from the same kind of area or whatever, then that would be, so not necessarily recorded.

Yeah, yeah, exactly. Um, all right. So I'm going to let you go back to the questionnaire one more time. I'll let you hear the same recordings again. And in this final part, you can rate them based on how supportive for coping with homesickness they feel too.

Okay. Sure.

All right. So let me know when you're ready for the first recording.

Okay. I'm ready.

[Voice recording audio: recording 1]

[Voice recording audio: recording 2]

[Voice recording audio: recording 9]

[Voice recording audio: recording 16]

[Voice recording audio: recording 23]

All right. So, what do you think are then the characteristics and the kind of specific elements that made it more good for coping with homesickness, or maybe worse than homesickness if they did?

The two French recordings, not really relevant at all. And then the last couple, I rated the weather forecast as much more supportive, just because it sort of, it kind of makes me feel connected to home still, to know the weather forecast, as simple as that is. And also, like, it was just such a comforting, familiar voice, with memories attached to it, and a feeling attached to it. And then with the president's speech, I rated that as, like, not supportive, because, yeah, I just didn't have a personal connection to it, beyond the couple of words that she spoke in Irish. Because I think that makes me, like, anytime I hear the Irish language, it brings me, like, a sense of pride to hear it spoken. And then, uh, the last one I rated is not supportive, either, because that's also just, yeah, I feel like I could be, uh, a news story everywhere. Um, uh, it's a, it's a parade, it's a celebration, that's not really anything to do with my experience.

Yeah. Yeah. So, finally, I would like you to imagine a voice recording, or maybe you could have a specific one in mind, of someone very close to you. So, like, a family member, loved one, good friend, anyone like that. And they're speaking to you directly about something personal. Um, how meaningful do you think that would be, such a recording? And how supportive for coping with homesickness do you think it would be?

Um, I've actually, yeah, I, I have a couple of voice recordings that I sometimes choose to listen to. What's different about it, though, is that they're recordings of, like, my granny talking to my mum, or, like, my dad talking to his mates and stuff. And it's not really, like, directed at me. So, it's not, like, a personal message.

Yeah.

Um, so I think, actually, those types of voice recordings feel, uh, more authentic or more, uh, helpful in coping with homesickness than, say, if my, my mum recorded a message directly for me, like, a voicemail. It just feels like you're more immersed in a situation that's really happening.

Yes. So, you would say it's more supportive than that it worsens the homesickness?

Um, yeah, I would say that it's more supportive.

All right. Um, so is there anything that we haven't talked about that might have, um, come up for you that you still feel is important to share?

Um, yeah. I think it's, it's interesting. Like, when I was going through the, the voice recordings from the French, uh, like, weather report and historical speech, that, uh, it made me think as well, like, if I was trying not to think of, of home. Yeah. And then, that can also be supportive in a sense. Yeah. That it's, it brings you out of that, like, headspace. Yeah. So, yeah, it's just, for me, it would just really depend on, on my

feeling and, like, the mood I'm in or, um, yeah, what's happening at home as well. It feels like, yeah, I don't know. It's really, it's really interesting to think about. Yeah. Um, but, yeah, ultimately, just from my own experience, that having those voice recordings of my, um, my parents and my, my granny and, um, yeah, listening to those every now and again, when I feel like it or I remember that I have them, then I can, it's mostly supportive. Yeah. And I didn't even think why I did that before. It was just something that I did and I was like, I wouldn't have really called it homesickness until you start to think about it and give it that label. So, yeah.

Yeah. All right. Thank you so much.

You're welcome.

I'm going to stop the recording now.

First broad notes

Participant mood	Pretty good
What 'home' means	Amsterdam
Most homesick	Comes in waves, so sometimes it just happens
Why homesick?	- Missing family and the environment (the countryside) - Part of me is missing, my heart is somewhere else - Missing connection
Personal voice audio	- Irish/native accent - Gaelic accent - Unfamiliar language - Everyday thing; e.g. weather report of Ireland
Generic voice audio	- Unfamiliar language from a country I have been to is still generic, but not very generic - Historical speech and national holiday → associated with Ireland but not personal to me
Meaningfulness of voice audio	- Historical speech - National holiday not so meaningful; standard and tourist-y - Family - Irish music - Unfamiliar language → not meaningful - Weather report native language - Uplifting tone of voice - Softer voice - Positive recording context

Difference of situations meaningfulness	- Depends on what's going on, what is affecting me in life - Being alone and not busy makes a recording of mom more meaningful
Supportiveness for coping with homesickness of voice audio	- Irish music → worsens homesickness - Radio from home → alleviates homesickness - Recordings of loved ones talking to each other are more supportive for coping with homesickness than it being directed to me personally
Difference of situations supportiveness	- Listening to something from Ireland intentionally, like the radio, could alleviate homesickness, but hearing it unplanned could worsen it - Something suddenly reminding you of home makes homesickness worse, but intentionality leads to alleviation of homesickness
Notable quote(s)	- Voice recordings of loved ones talking to each other feels more authentic and you feel more immersed than when it's directly addressed to you - Intentionally listening to a voice recording can help with alleviation of homesickness, but hearing one unexpectedly can worsen it

Important recording(s)	Granny talking to my mum, dad talking to his mates
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Initial Codes

- Homesickness comes in waves
- Homesickness → part of me is missing
- Everyday things
- Things about native country
- Unfamiliar language is generic
- Tone of voice
- Softness of voice
- Positive recording context
- Being alone affects meaningfulness
- Being busy affects meaningfulness
- What's going on in life affects meaningfulness
- Radio from home
- Recordings of loved ones talking to each other
- Intentionality of listening affects supportiveness
- Sudden reminder of home